



Hopepunk explained

How do you weaponise something like optimism? Find out what hopepunk is all about. <https://digit.in/jan20-07>



Voldemorting

Even for youth-speak, the Macmillan Dictionary is at times better than Urban Dictionary. <https://digit.in/jan20-08>

SETTLING THE SCORE

A roundup of emerging trends and new words in December 2019.

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YOUTH-SPEAK

This is the word now for lingo of the post millennials, who just seem to be innovating 4ever in the language space. Listening to it makes you want the yooof to get some milk and glo up. See how redonkulous it is? Enough to make anyone salty. We actually like some of the emerging anthimeria, where adjectives are used as adverbs as in, "I've low key fallen sick", or nouns are used as verbs, our favorite being "desk him!". With these few exceptions, while kids might think speaking in meme is sick, we think it is basic. We can only wish the whole awks thing is cancelled.



DELHI WEATHER

This was something that continued to trend through December, considering the poor air quality typically seen in the winters. According to some international researchers, the areas in India just below the Himalayas have practically the worst air quality anywhere in the world. This is because the mountain ranges trap the pollutants, and the winds from the lower latitudes constantly replenish the particles. The cold air from the Himalayas prevent the polluted air from going into Tibet. The polluted air slowly moves towards Bangladesh.



SCORE

This is one of those things that are amazing about technology. During the T20 series between India and West Indies, one of the top trending searches on Google in India was simply "score". What is even better is that such a badly described search phrase actually ends up getting the users exactly what they are looking for, while taking minimal effort as well. The search engine is smart enough to realise that users in India are probably looking for the cricket

HOT!



score of the ongoing T20 match. This is one of those things that make you realise the magical times that we live in.



HOPEPUNK

Hopepunk is the new name of a genre where everyone sees the world through rose tinted glasses. The gore and violence is reduced, there is barely any tension, and everyone just happens to live in a perfect and beautiful world. Even if the characters are living in a post apocalyptic wasteland, they are just incredibly optimistic and are doing what it takes to fix the world. While the name itself is new, it has been applied retroactively to works.

HOT!

Popular hopepunk books include The Expanse and The Martian. Brooklyn Nine-Nine, Doctor Who and She-Ra and the Princesses of Power are good examples of hopepunk TV shows.



BABY YODA

While officially known as The Child, Baby Yoda has taken over the internet, clearly replacing the previous crowd favorite, Baby Groot. He is considered to be the cutest thing you will ever see, which is not surprising as he seems to have been designed with all the characteristic traits of cuteness - large eyes, a tiny nose, and a reduced chin. Every second of screen time by Baby Yoda has been memefied, eclipsing all the other meme worthy moments in The Mandalorian, and there are plenty of these. Personally, we would prefer Veidt's baby squid, especially if it is on a plate, but we have to go with the crowd here.

HOT!



VOLDEMORTING

This is one of those examples of youth-speak that we can live with, especially considering how appropriate it is.

HOT!

Don't look up the meaning of the word on Urban Dictionary though, especially if you are in public, where people can peek at your screen. The idea is to not give attention to a particular celebrity, franchise or concept, by avoiding all mentions of the said celebrity, franchise or concept, and using an easily understandable alternative name instead. So by referring to Facebook as Fakebook, you can trip search engines and social media trackers. This is so effective that we are now wondering why people simply did not refer to he who must not be named as baldymart. 